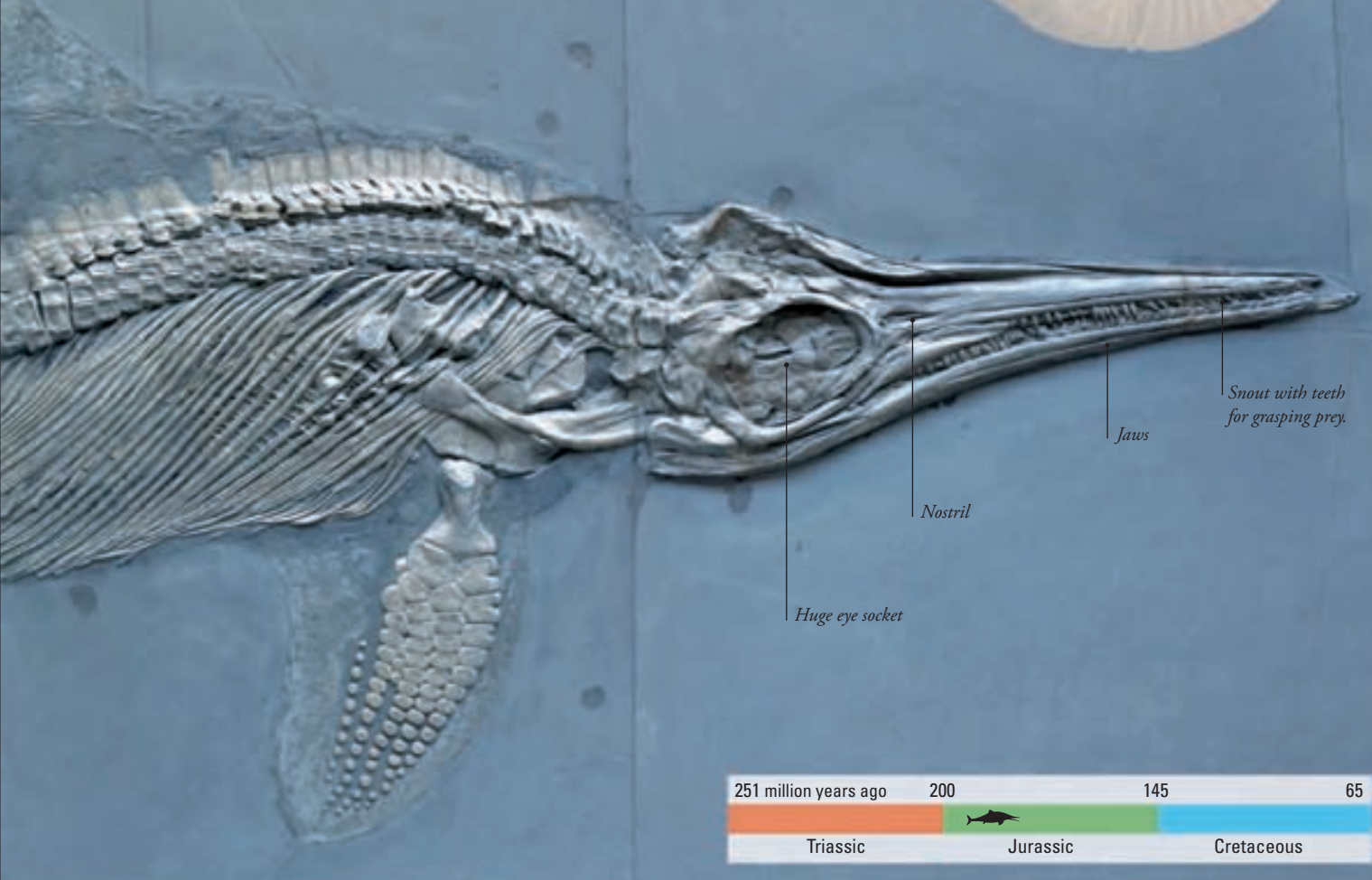


Studies of *Stenopterygius*'s

beautifully preserved fossils suggest it was a fast swimmer—at least as swift as the fastest fish alive today.



Birth of young

Although ichthyosaurs lived millions of years ago, we know that these marine animals gave birth to live young rather than laying eggs. How do we know? It's because fossils have been discovered that show females giving birth (always tail first). However, it's highly unlikely that the parent cared for its young after birth.

► ICHTHYOSAUR YOUNG, such as *this Stenopterygius*, were probably self-sufficient soon after birth.

